TidyTuesday Week 43

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Monday 19th October, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to another thrilling installment of "What Happens When You Throw Two Economic Series In A Blender And Hit Go." This week featured exactly one matchup, and honestly, after seeing the results, I understand why the universe decided one was enough. In the red corner, we have the Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors for Light Truck Production – a series so niche and so beloved that FRED rates its popularity at a cool "1." In the blue corner, the Export Price Index for Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum, because aluminum, as always, gets its own table at the party). Also popularity 1. Truly a clash of titans that no one asked for.

The raw regression came back with a p-value of 0.926, which is statistics-speak for "please stop looking at me." The R-squared clocked in at roughly 0.000035, meaning the light truck seasonal factor explains approximately zero percent of the metal export prices, give or take zero percent. For a project that lives and breathes off spurious correlations propped up by shared trends, this is almost disappointing – we didn't even get a trend mirage to dunk on. The two series couldn't be bothered to drift in the same direction together, let alone pretend to have a relationship.

And then, as if to twist the knife, the detrended version somehow did even less. P-value of 0.886, R-squared of 0.00008, and a slope so flat you could use it as a spirit level. Normally the detrended regression is where we catch raw "hits" red-handed as frauds, but there was nothing to catch here – this relationship was dead on arrival in both rounds, which, I'll grudgingly admit, makes it unusually consistent. Zero relationship raw, zero relationship detrended. At least it's honest.

As always, the obligatory reminder: these series were paired by a random number generator with no judgment, taste, or shame, and absolutely no causal or rigorous statistical claim is being made. Spurious correlation is the house specialty around here; a genuine nothingburger like this week's is actually the rare refreshing palate cleanser. Light truck seasonal factors do not move nonferrous metal export prices, nobody thought they did, and now we have a p-value of 0.93 to not prove it. See you next week for more of the same.

2 Date: 2026-10-19

Series ID: G17MVSFWLTRUCKS
This series is titled Weekday-Basis Seasonal Factors: Light Truck Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: IY3314
This series is titled Export Price Index (NAICS): Nonferrous Metal (Except Aluminum) Production and Processing and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted.The observation start date is 2005-12-01 and the observation end date is 2026-09-01.The popularity of this series is 1.

2.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.008633
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.926
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1453.3
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2911.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2918.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	224.0975	50.852	4.407	0.000	123.938	324.257
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS	-0.0470	0.506	-0.093	0.926	-1.044	0.950

Omnibus:	96.948	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.011
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	270.714
Skew:	1.770	**Prob(JB):**	1.64e-59
Kurtosis:	6.683	**Cond. No.**	969.

Notes:
[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

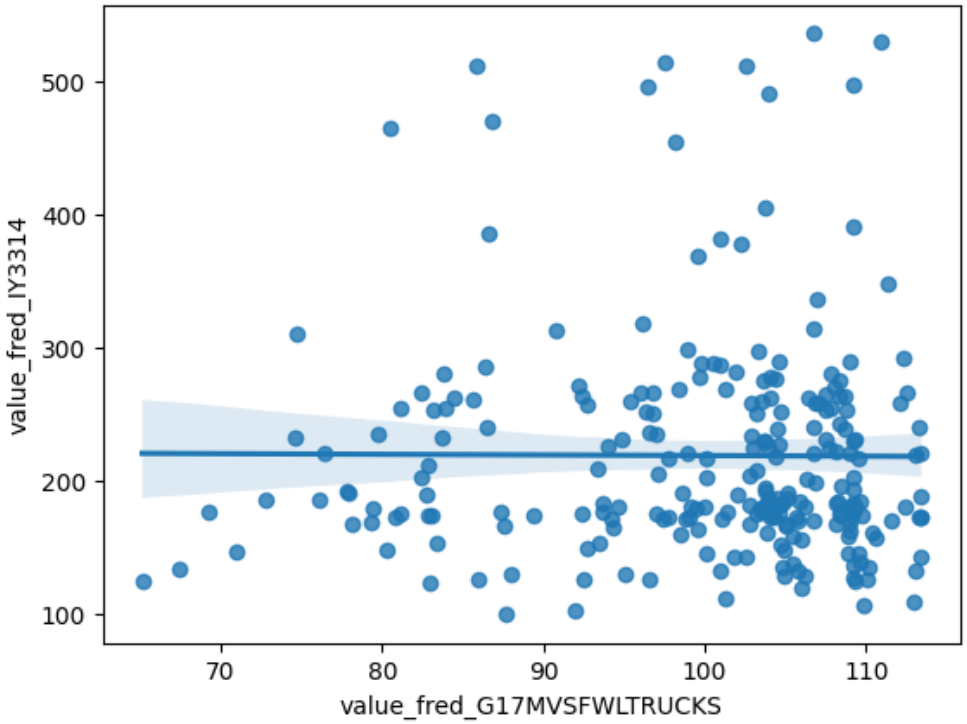


Figure 1: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-10-19

2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_IY3314_detrended	**R-squared:**	0.000
Model:	OLS	**Adj. R-squared:**	-0.004
Method:	Least Squares	**F-statistic:**	0.02068
Date:	Mon, 19 Oct 2026	**Prob (F-statistic):**	0.886
Time:	17:51:42	**Log-Likelihood:**	-1346.8
No. Observations:	249	**AIC:**	2698.
Df Residuals:	247	**BIC:**	2705.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	**std err**	**t**	**P> |t|**	**[0.025**	**0.975]**
const	-6.754e-12	3.439	-1.96e-12	1.000	-6.774	6.774
value_fred_G17MVSFWLTRUCKS_detrended	0.0475	0.330	0.144	0.886	-0.603	0.697

Omnibus:	75.189	**Durbin-Watson:**	0.024
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	**Jarque-Bera (JB):**	174.874
Skew:	1.427	**Prob(JB):**	1.06e-38
Kurtosis:	5.952	**Cond. No.**	10.4

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

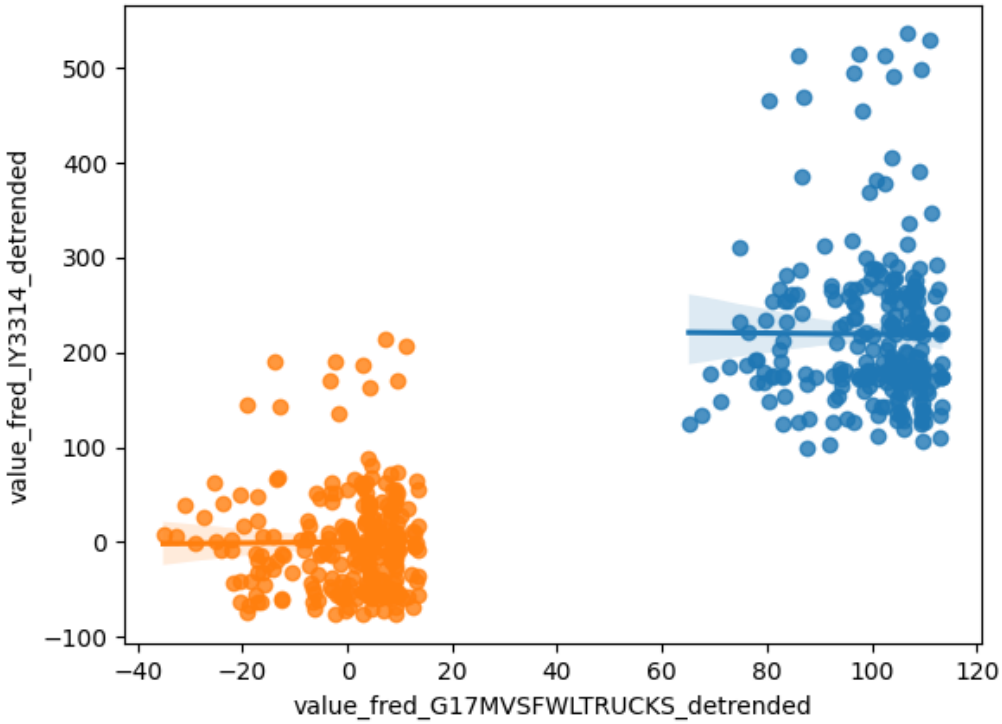


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-10-19